

Expand All

VMware vSphere Product Documentation

- ☐ vSphere Virtual Machine Administration
 - ☐ Updated Information
 - ☐ Introduction to VMware vSphere Virtual Machines
 - ☐ Deploying Virtual Machines
 - ☐ Deploying OVF and OVA Templates
 - ☐ Using Content Libraries
 - ☐ Configuring Virtual Machine Hardware
 - ☐ Virtual Machine Compatibility
 - ☐ Virtual CPU Configuration
 - ☐ Virtual Memory Configuration
 - ☐ Virtual Disk Configuration
 - ☐ SCSI, SATA, and NVMe Storage Controller Conditions, Limitations, and Compatibility
 - ☐ Virtual Machine Network Configuration
 - ☐ Other Virtual Machine Device Configuration
 - ☐ Securing Virtual Machines with Intel Software Guard Extensions
 - ☐ USB Configuration from an ESXi Host to a Virtual Machine
 - ☐ USB Autoconnect Feature
 - ☐ vSphere Features Available with USB

Docs / VMware vSphere / vSphere Virtual Machine Administration

Add USB Devices to an ESXi Host

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Selected product version: VMware vSphere 7.0

You can connect multiple USB devices to an ESXi host so that the virtual machines that run on the same host can access the devices. The number of devices that you can connect depends on the device type and how the devices and hubs chain together.

Each ESXi host has several USB ports. The number of ports on each host depends on the physical setup of the host. When you calculate the depth of hub chaining, remember that on a typical server the front ports connect to an internal hub.

The USB arbitrator can monitor a maximum of 15 USB controllers. If your system includes more than 15 controllers and you connect USB devices to them, the devices are not available to the virtual machine.

The host treats USB CD/DVD-ROM devices as SCSI devices.

Prerequisites

- If a host has attached USB devices and resides in a DRS cluster with activated DPM, deactivate DPM for that host. For instructions about overriding the default DPM setting for a single host, see *vSphere Resource Management*.
- To verify that the virtual machine meets the requirements for the USB device connection, see [Connecting USB Devices to an ESXi Host](#).
- To add eight xHCI controllers to the ESXi host, verify that the current version of your ESXi host is 6.0 or later.

Procedure

- To add a USB device to an ESXi host, connect the device to an available port or hub.

What to do next

You can add the device to the virtual machine. See [Add USB Devices from an ESXi Host to a Virtual Machine](#).

Parent topic: [USB Configuration from an ESXi Host to a Virtual Machine](#)

Previous Page

Next Page

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Communities

Support

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Support Policies

Product Documentation

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- ☐ vSphere Virtual Machine Administration
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 - ☐ Virtual Memory Configuration
 - ☐ Virtual Disk Configuration
 - ☐ SCSI, SATA, and NVMe Storage Controller Conditions, Limitations, and Compatibility
 - ☐ Virtual Machine Network Configuration
 - ☐ Other Virtual Machine Device Configuration
 - ☐ Securing Virtual Machines with Intel Software Guard Extensions
 - ☐ USB Configuration from an ESXi Host to a Virtual Machine
 - ☐ USB Autoconnect Feature
 - ☐ vSphere Features Available with USB

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COVID-19 Resources

Statement

f Use

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Privacy

Accessibility

Trademarks

Glossary

Help

Feedback

In this article X

[Prerequisites](#)

[Procedure](#)

[What to do next](#)

[Send Feedback](#)

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